

The Hiring Report | 2022

An overview of the UK's startup and
scaleup recruitment landscape



The current state of startup and scaleup recruitment in the UK

What does startup recruitment look like in 2022? According to Beauhurst's own Recruitment Manager, Joe Hodgson:



“It’s a really interesting time for recruiters. The hiring market is very volatile at the minute, especially here in the UK — some companies have overextended themselves and are making redundancies, whilst others are thriving, raising large sums of investment and putting that towards recruitment drives.

It’s a candidate-driven market right now, and the tech industry in particular is willing to pay over the odds to meet that shortfall. So it’s crucial for recruiters to find and latch on to those cash-rich companies with really strong growth trajectories (and not waste time on those that are struggling).”

Around 30% of high-growth UK companies are expanding their teams right now — that’s nearly 14k businesses on the lookout for new talent. This report explores the data on these companies, to spot key trends in the market.

What do we mean by high-growth?

We use eight different criteria to identify high-growth and ambitious businesses. Each of these is a sign that a company is actively growing or creating ambitious growth plans.

All of the companies featured in this report have met at least one of our high-growth triggers, and are hence tracked on the Beauhurst platform.



Equity investment



Accelerator attendance



Scaleups



MBO/MBI



Academic spinouts



Major grant recipients



High-growth lists



Venture debt

How do we know that a business is hiring?



Beauhurst's actively hiring data runs over all of our 45k+ tracked companies, and can be used within our Advanced Search feature to find the businesses most relevant to you. Our analysts use publicly available information to ascertain whether a company is currently hiring:

- The company itself must have open job roles (recruitment agencies hiring into client companies but not into themselves would not count)
- A job listing must have a job title and/or job description
- Job pages that only contain a generic message such as “we’re always looking for new talent — get in touch” are not sufficient

This data is essential for recruiters searching for new clients, but also accelerators and funds looking to track the success of their portfolios, and government bodies or LEPs wanting to understand the health of local business ecosystems.

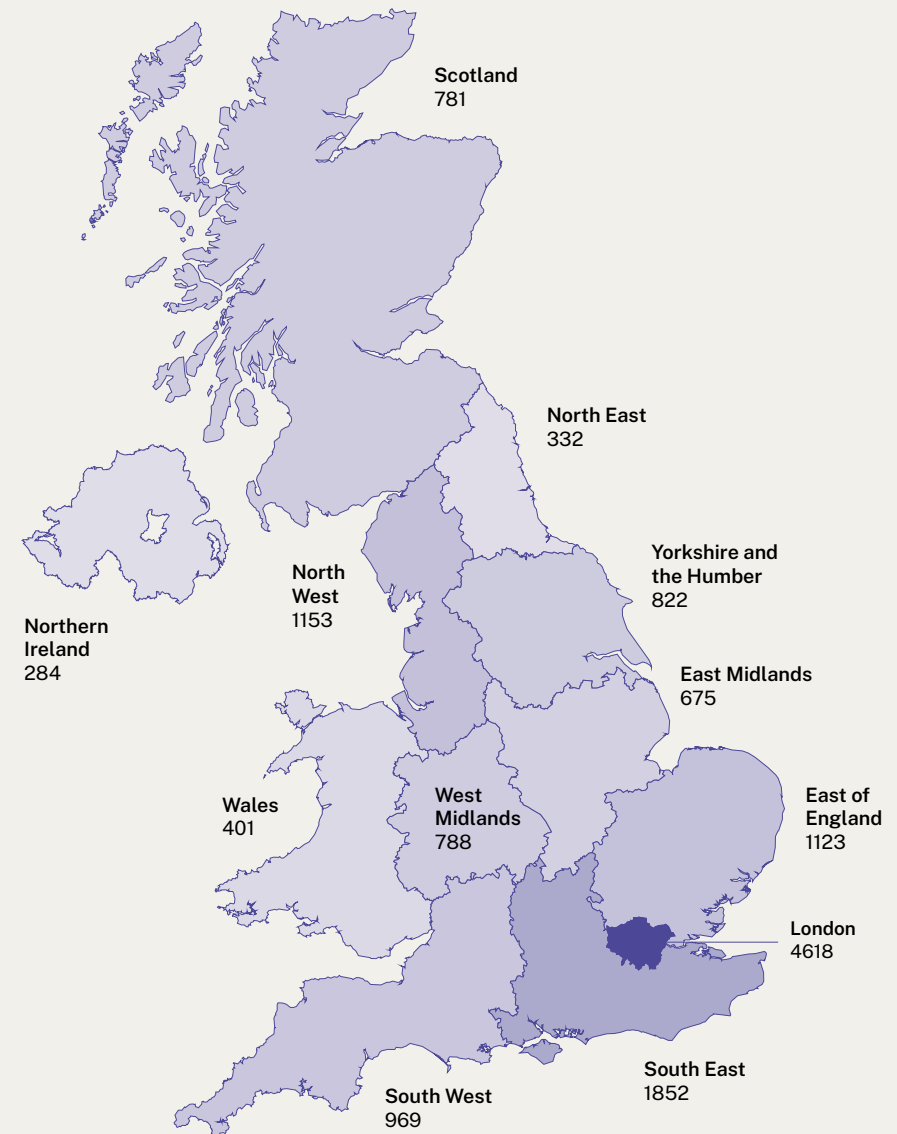
Which UK regions have the most actively hiring companies?

London has both the greatest number of actively hiring companies (4,618) and the largest proportion, at 33% of its high-growth business population — tied with the East Midlands, despite its relatively small number of actively hiring companies (675).

Wales and Scotland, on the other hand, have the lowest hiring rates. Even still, an impressive 1 in 4 companies are actively hiring in those regions (401 and 781 businesses, respectively).

Hiring rates in the North East and South East also come in slightly below the national average, at 27%, while the remaining regions are in line with the wider UK (~30%).

At a local authority level, besides areas within London, Edinburgh and Leeds have the highest number of actively hiring companies in the UK.



Number of actively hiring companies in each UK region

Olsam

The logo for Olsam, featuring the word "Olsam." in a bold, black, serif font.

Sector:
E-commerce

Stage:
Venture

Location:
London

Current employee count:
50-99

Current vacancies

Data Engineer, London
Supply Chain Coordinator, London
Demand Planning Manager, London

Olsam acquires FBA (Fulfilled by Amazon) e-commerce businesses, migrating assets such as website domains and software tools to its ownership. It then helps to scale these brands, providing capital investment and supply chain expertise.

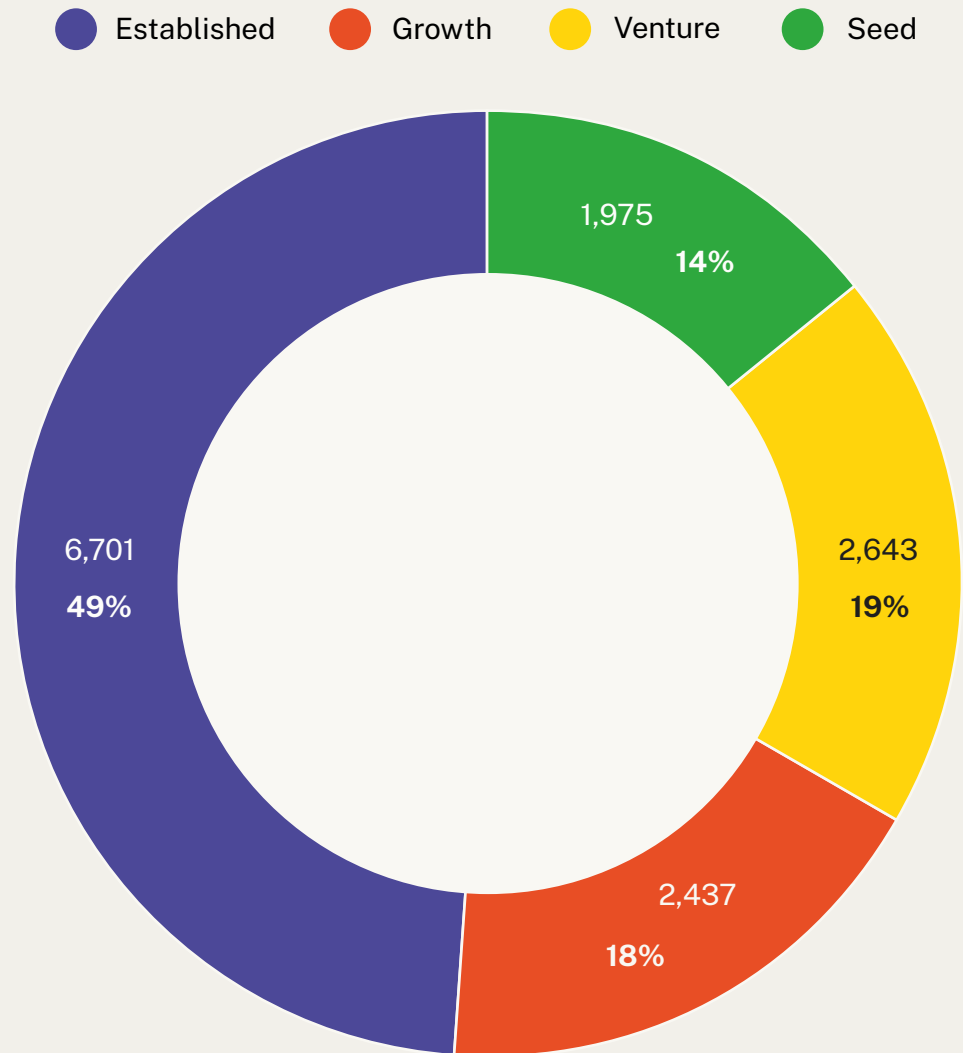
Olsam has raised £121m in equity fundraisings so far, with its latest round in September 2021 intended to invest in the company's platform, expand its IP and patent protection, fund more acquisitions, and grow its operations team. In May 2022, Olsam also acquired US e-commerce brand platform MarketFleet.

The company offers 30 days of holiday to new employees, regular team socials, and a flexible office space with drinks on tap, an on-site barista, and table tennis.

The most common stage of evolution for expanding companies

Despite being the most negatively affected by COVID-19 at the beginning of the pandemic, Established-stage companies are now the most likely to be growing their teams. These tend to be older businesses (usually 15+ years), with multiple offices and a sustained turnover well into the millions. Nearly half (49%) of high-growth companies that are actively hiring right now are operating at this stage.

Seed startups are the least likely to be recruiting right now, accounting for just 14% of actively hiring companies, while businesses operating at the Venture and Growth stages account for 19% and 18%, respectively.



Stages of evolution of actively hiring companies

Dubit



Sector:
Online games publishing

Stage:
Established

Location:
Leeds

Current employee count:
100-249

Current vacancies

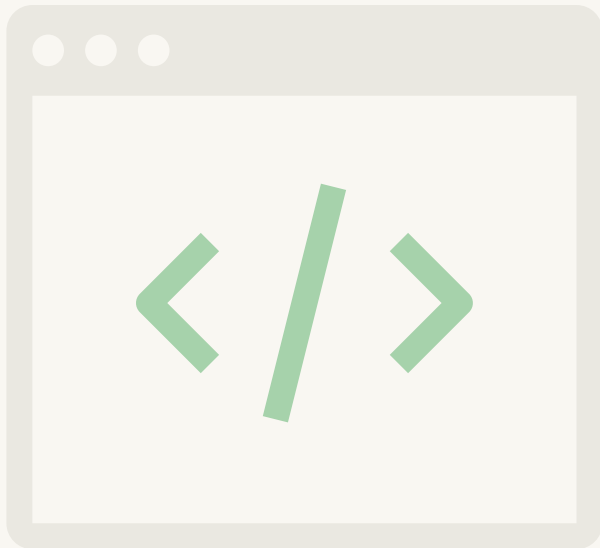
Head of Studio Production, Remote
Account Manager, Remote
Senior Game Designer, Remote
Roblox Developer Freelancer, Remote
Roblox Builder, Remote

Dubit produces online games for use in the metaverse, specialising in esports and children's gaming. The company develops research tools that assist its Consulting, Development and Marketing teams in incorporating a child's perspective into the product development process.

The Leeds-based games developer has been awarded £183k worth of Innovate UK grants so far. It has also secured one equity investment, in November 2021 – the £5.90m fundraising saw participation from Brazilian fund Meta Ventures, alongside angel investors. With this funding, Dubit intends to launch a live esports league in the metaverse, initially on the Roblox platform.

Dubit offers its employees 25 days holiday, company away days, and paid training and personal development.

Top sectors for startup and scaleup jobs

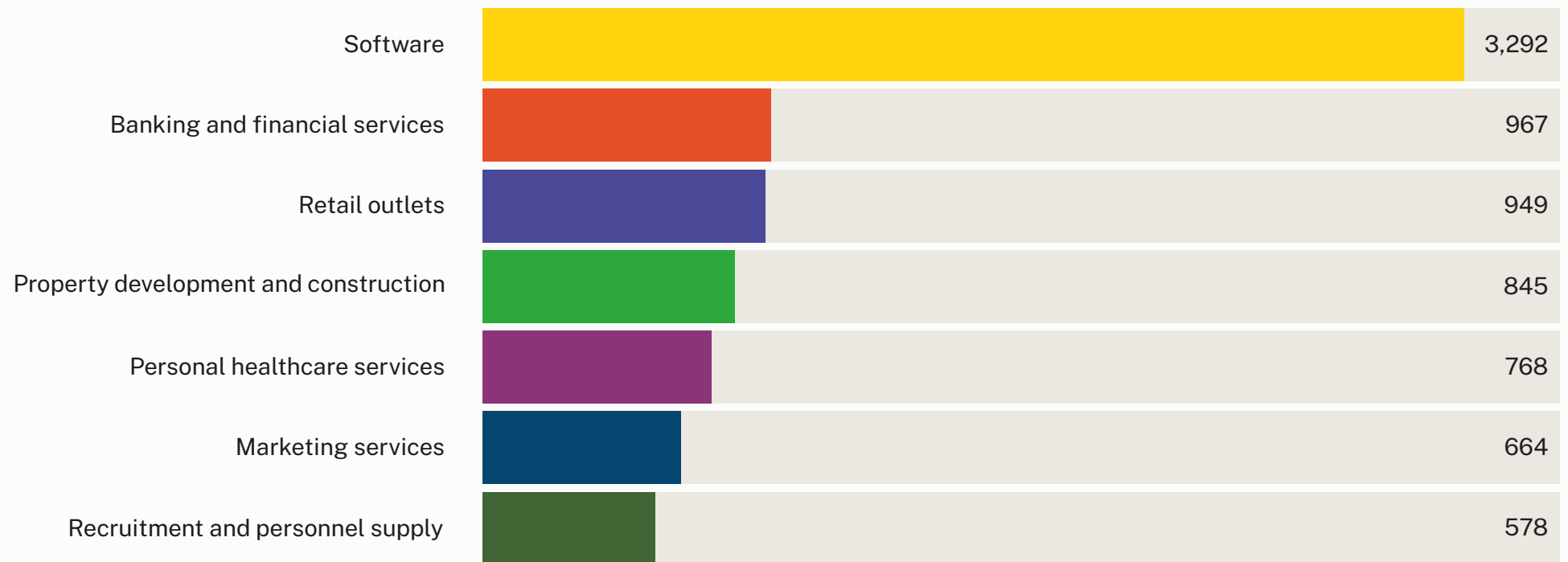


Of the high-growth UK companies that are hiring right now, 50% operate in Business & Professional Services. Particularly strong are the banking, marketing and recruitment sectors.

Meanwhile, 31% are Technology/IP-based businesses, which covers everything from software and cleantech to hardware and life sciences. Within this industry, we currently track 1,419 software-as-a-service (SaaS) companies that are looking to grow their teams.

Industrials is also a top industry, accounting for 24% of actively hiring companies in the UK.

In contrast, just 10% operate in each of the Retail, Personal Services and Leisure & Entertainment spaces — perhaps unsurprising, given the challenges faced by these industries during COVID-19. Nonetheless, they still boast a large number of ambitious businesses that are looking to make new hires.



Top sectors by number of actively hiring companies

RegTick



Sector:
Software-as-a-service

Stage:
Seed

Location:
Belfast

Current employee count:
<5

Current vacancies

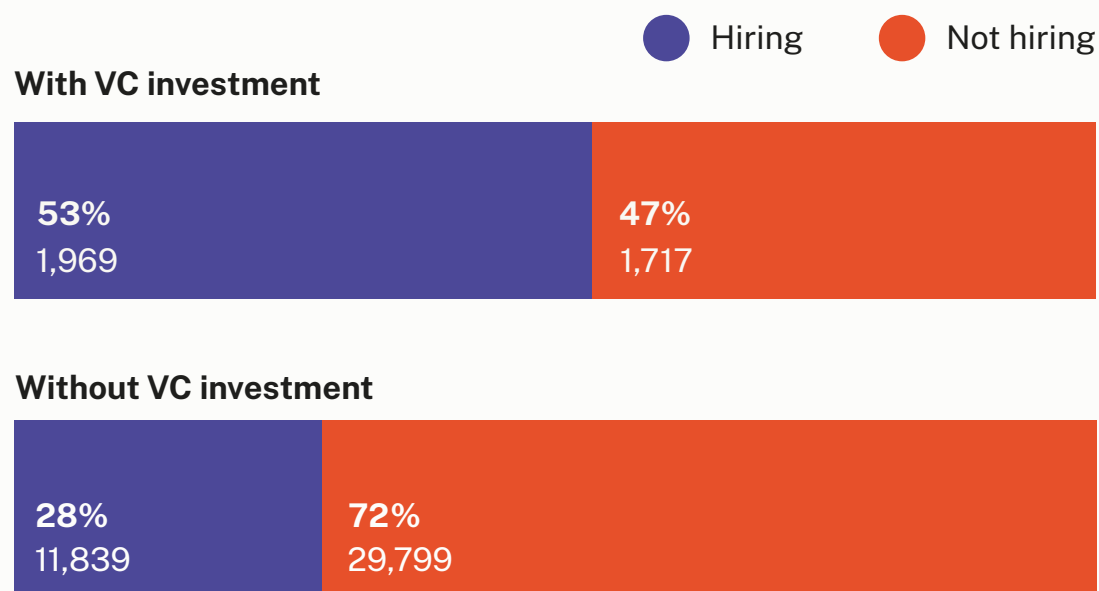
Senior DevOps Engineer Remote/Hybrid, Belfast
Senior Front End Developer, Remote/Hybrid, Belfast
Senior Back End Developer, Remote/Hybrid, Belfast

RegTick develops an online platform that aims to simplify regulatory compliance for businesses. The compliance management platform was created for distributed teams in the financial services, healthcare and insurance industries, enabling users to collaborate on challenging projects from anywhere in the world.

In March 2022, the Belfast-based SaaS startup secured a £1.00m equity investment from Northern Irish businessman Tom O’Gorman. The investment will support RegTick to develop new products, scale internationally, and expand its tech team, creating 30 new jobs.

RegTick offers flexible working, with remote or hybrid options for all of its open roles.

How much more likely are VC-backed companies to be hiring?



Proportion of companies with/without VC investment that are actively hiring

The UK is home to 5,737 actively hiring companies that have secured equity funding. This still leaves 8,071 high-growth companies that are expanding their teams despite never raising equity finance. Roughly the same proportion of businesses that have raised equity investment are actively hiring than those without it (30-31%).

Having said that, when breaking the data down by investor type, companies backed by private equity or venture capital funds are considerably more likely to be recruiting than their peers: an impressive 53% of VC-backed businesses are actively hiring, compared to just 28% of companies that haven't secured VC investment.

Pockit



Sector:
Fintech

Stage:
Growth

Location:
Cardiff

Current employee count:
50-99

Current vacancies

Head of Engineering, London
Cloud Engineer, Newcastle
Growth Marketer, London
HR Manager, Newcastle

Pockit produces prepaid credit cards that also provide discounts and cashback from associated retailers. The Welsh fintech company aims to make money simple for low-income, 'unbanked' customers. It attended both the Govstart and Upscale accelerator programmes in 2017 and has featured in several high-growth lists.

To date, Pockit has raised £28.9m in equity investment, across 10 funding rounds. Investors include the North East Fund, Crowdcube, and VCT and private equity firm Maven. The company's most recent fundraising was a £2.45m unannounced round, completed in February 2022.

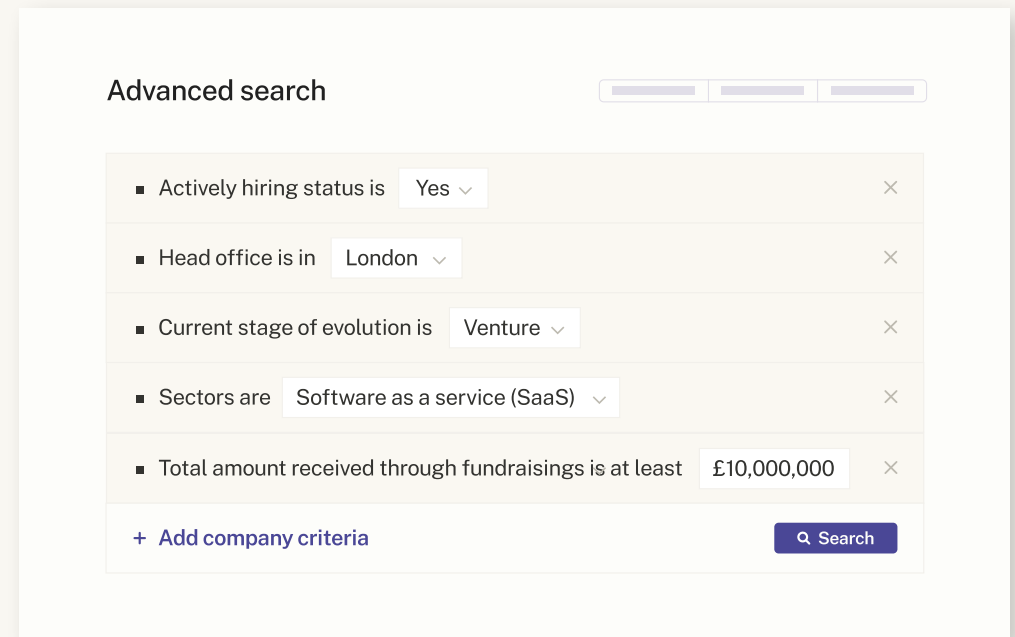
The company offers its employees 25 days of annual leave, Perkbox rewards, and regular company away days.

How to find startups that are hiring in the UK

With Beauhurst, you could find thousands more actively hiring companies, in the time it took you to read this sentence.

Using our Advanced Search feature, you can even filter down by criteria like location, sector, stage of evolution and fundraisings.

You'll then have access to extensive profiles for these businesses, plus verified contact details for key decision makers. That way, you can reach out to the right leads, at the right time, and be fully prepared for each conversation.



The screenshot displays the 'Advanced search' interface of the Beauhurst platform. It features a list of five filter criteria, each with a dropdown menu and a clear button (X). The filters are: 'Actively hiring status is' set to 'Yes', 'Head office is in' set to 'London', 'Current stage of evolution is' set to 'Venture', 'Sectors are' set to 'Software as a service (SaaS)', and 'Total amount received through fundraisings is at least' set to '£10,000,000'. Below the filters is a link to '+ Add company criteria' and a 'Search' button.

Filter	Value	Action
Actively hiring status is	Yes	×
Head office is in	London	×
Current stage of evolution is	Venture	×
Sectors are	Software as a service (SaaS)	×
Total amount received through fundraisings is at least	£10,000,000	×

[+ Add company criteria](#) [Search](#)

Book a demo of the Beauhurst platform to find out more

**So far, we've grown our client base
by 230% using Beauhurst — which
is absolutely brilliant.**

PETE ROWE, CO-FOUNDER

